

SPORTSTAR OF THE YEAR (FEMALE)

Lovlina Borgohain

Age: 26



Discipline: Boxing

The bronze medallist at the Tokyo Olympics was crowned the World Champion in the women's 75kg category, becoming only the second Indian

women's boxer, after Mary Kom, to medal at the Olympics and the Worlds. Lovlina, who shifted from 69kg (in which she won the Olympic bronze) to 75kg, pipped two-time Commonwealth Games medallist Caitlin Parker 5-2 through bout review to pocket her maiden World title, helping India get level with its most successful campaign in the Worlds. At the Asian Games, she won silver, losing to Li Qian in the final, securing her spot in the Paris 2024 Olympics. HINDUSTAN

TIMES VIA GETTY IMAGES

Esha Singh

Age: 18



Discipline: Shooting

Esha, along with Shiva Narwal, topped the 10m air pistol mixed team field at the World Shooting Championships to become the only

gold medallist in an Olympic category. She also clinched gold in the 25m pistol women's team event at the Championships. In Hangzhou, Esha won two gold and two silver medals, including an individual gold and silver, helping India to its best-ever campaign in shooting in the tournament. HINDUSTAN

TIMES VIA GETTY IMAGES

Parul Chaudhary

Age: 28



Discipline: 3000m, 3000m

Steeplechase, 5000m Parul Chaudhary ended 2023 with three national records — women's 3000m (8:57.19), 3000m

steeplechase (9:15.31), and 5000m (15:10.35) — and an Asian Games silver and gold medal in the women's 3000m steeplechase and 5000m, respectively. She also had an impressive World Championships, where she registered a personal best in the 3000m steeplechase to qualify for the final. She then proceeded to smash Lalita Babar's national record in the final, where she finished 11th to qualify for the Paris Olympics. AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Sheetal Devi

Age: 16



Discipline: Para Archery (Compound Open)

Born with Phocomelia, a disorder causing under-developed limbs, Sheetal Devi is the world's first armless woman archer (Open Compound). Ranked World No. 3 as of October 2023, she captured everyone's attention with her steely-eyed attitude in

para-archery. This year, she became the world record holder in the women's doubles event at the Para Worlds, while at the World Archery Para Championships, she clinched a silver medal, making her the first female armless archer to do so. The Asian Para Games saw Sheetal's exceptional performance with three medals, including two gold and one silver. Notably, she became the first woman to secure two gold medals at the tournament, further solidifying her position as a trailblazer in the sport. HINDUSTAN

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Jyothi Surekha Vennam

Age: 27



Discipline: Compound Archery

India's golden girl in compound archery, Jyothi, bagged six medals (across stages) in the Archery World Cup, including four gold and two bronze medals. Her form remained unabated

at the World Championships, where she won gold with the women's team and bronze in the individual event. At the Asian Games, she completed a treble of gold medals in women's individual, mixed team, and women's team, helping India to its best-ever showing in compound archery at the Asiad. AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES